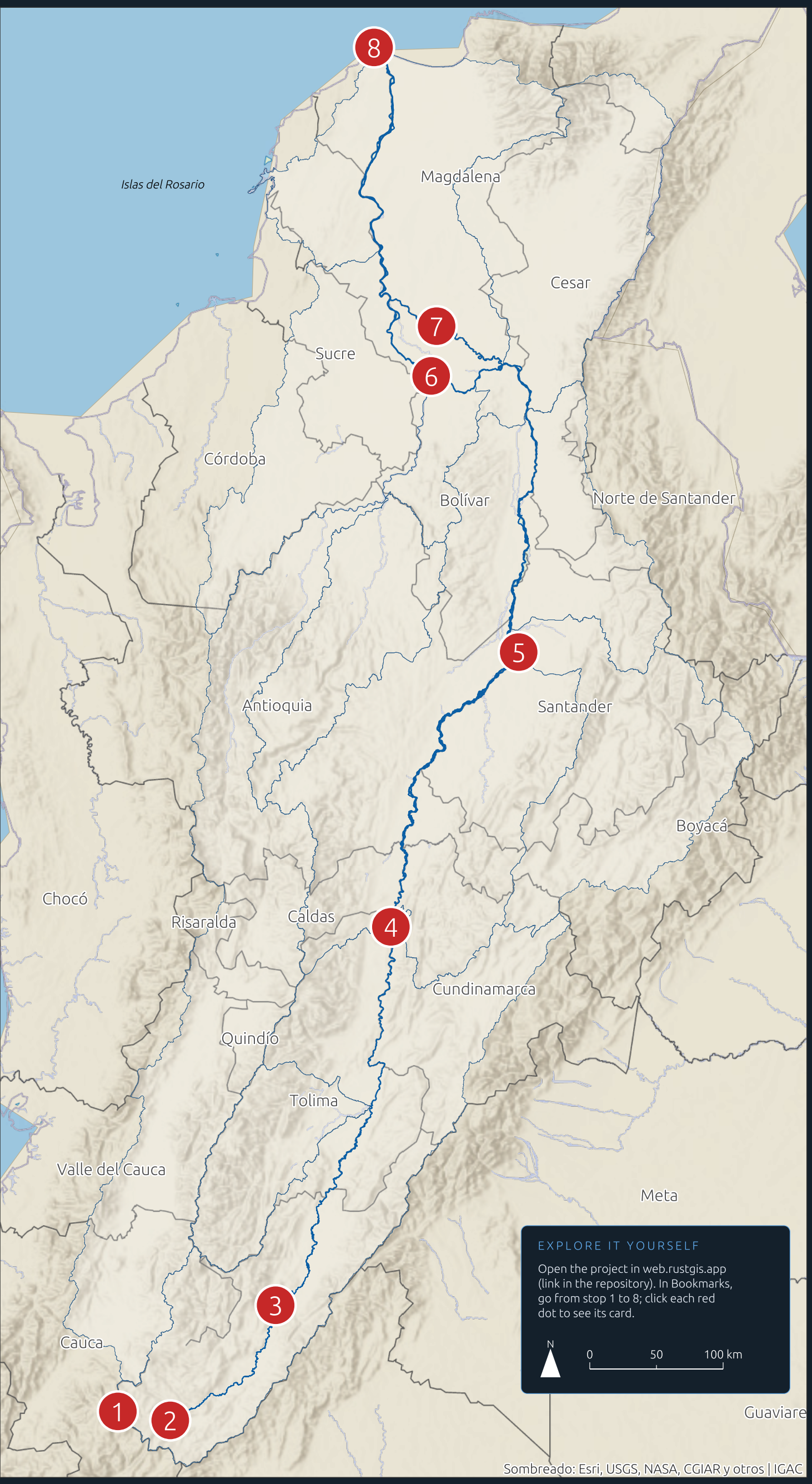
The Magdalena in eight stops

From the lake where it rises to Bocas de Ceniza: 1,528 km, through a basin that covers 23% of the country



THE JOURNEY

1

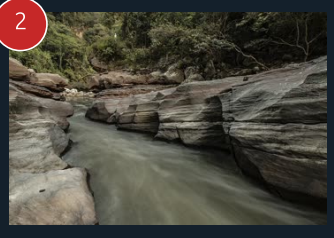


Laguna de la Magdalena

San Agustín (Huila)

The source, in the Páramo de Las Papas (Colombian Massif), inside Puracé National Park. Kilometre 0 of 1,528.

2

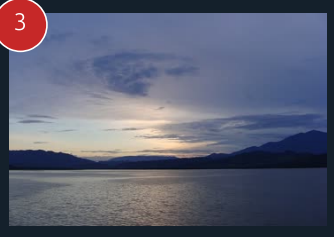


Magdalena Strait

San Agustín (Huila)

Near San Agustín, the river squeezes between rocks through a channel about 2.2 m wide.

3



Betania and El Quimbo

Yaguará and Gigante (Huila)

Two dams in a row: Betania (540 MW, since 1987) and El Quimbo (400 MW, since 2015).

4



Honda

Honda (Tolima)

The Honda rapids split navigation in two. The Upper Magdalena ends here: 565 km from the lake, at 229 m.

5



Barrancabermeja

Barrancabermeja (Santander)

The oil port: its refinery, from 1922, processes about 250,000 barrels a day.

6

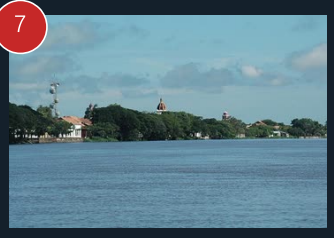


Confluence with the Cauca

Pinillos (Bolívar)

In the Brazo de Loba, near Pinillos, the Cauca joins the Magdalena.

7



Mompox

Santa Cruz de Mompox (Bolívar)

The Mompós branch runs past Santa Cruz de Mompox, a UNESCO World Heritage Site since 1995.

8



Bocas de Ceniza

Barranquilla (Atlántico)

The mouth, on the Caribbean. Its breakwaters opened on 22 December 1936.

Data: IGAC, Atlas of Colombia: Magdalena River (polygons from San Agustín to Bocas de Ceniza; the ~40 km reach from the lake is not in that layer) and the hydrographic zones of the Magdalena-Cauca area; IGAC physical basemap; hillshade: Esri World Hillshade. Dams: UPME, with XM data. Cards: Cormagdalena (length, Upper Magdalena), UNESCO, Ecopetrol, DIMAR and regional press, accessed 2026-11-11. How it was made: all in RustGIS web (web.rustgis.app), with four scripts: quantized PBF data, stops as GeoJSON written in the script, bookmarks and pop-up cards, and layouts. Scripts: github.com/jgregoriorincon/30DayMapChallenge-2026
Photos (Wikimedia Commons; each keeps its licence): 1 Knomrm (CC BY-SA 4.0); 2 Biodiego88 (CC BY 4.0); 3 Guillermo Vasquez (CC BY 2.0); 4 Mfrancoavellaneda (CC BY-SA 4.0); 5 Crystalarts (CC0); 6 Daniel Uribe Silva: Magangué, near the confluence, not the confluence itself (CC BY-SA 4.0); 7 O--o (CC BY 3.0); 8 Moyogo (CC BY-SA 2.5).